

Customer Returns and Warranty Policy

Document code	CSP-104
Owner	Customer Experience
Version	3.2
Effective date	1 July 2026

Purpose and document map

This policy defines how Northstar Electronics handles returns, exchanges, refunds, and warranty claims for products sold through company stores and northstarelectronics.example. It applies to consumer purchases in all operating regions unless local law provides stronger rights.

This version replaces CSP-104 version 2.8. The most important changes are the extension of the damaged-product return window to 30 calendar days and the introduction of a 24-month warranty for Northstar-branded devices.

Document map: eligibility and proof of purchase; standard returns; damaged or defective products; warranty coverage; exclusions; responsibilities and escalation. Questions should be directed to the Customer Care Policy Desk.

Contents

- 1. Purpose and document map
- 2. Eligibility and proof of purchase
- 3. Standard returns
- 4. Damaged or defective products
- 5. Warranty coverage
- 6. Exclusions and special categories
- 7. Responsibilities, controls, and revision history

2. Eligibility and proof of purchase

A return must be linked to an order number, store receipt, or verified customer account. Digital receipts are acceptable. Gift recipients may receive store credit when the original payment method cannot be verified.

Returned products must include the main device and any safety-critical accessories. Missing packaging alone does not make a damaged-product claim ineligible, although missing components may reduce a discretionary refund for non-defective returns.

Marketplace purchases fulfilled by third-party sellers follow the seller's published policy. Northstar Customer Care may still record a complaint and escalate repeated product-quality issues to Vendor Operations.

3. Standard returns

Unopened products may be returned within 30 calendar days after delivery. Opened, non-defective accessories may be returned within 14 calendar days when they are complete and in resalable condition.

Refunds are normally issued to the original payment method within five business days after inspection. Bank processing can add additional time. Store teams must not promise an exact settlement date controlled by a payment provider.

Business-to-business orders with negotiated terms are excluded from this standard window and must follow the contract recorded in the account file.

4. Damaged or defective products

A product that arrives damaged, fails initial setup, or develops a confirmed manufacturing fault may be returned within 30 calendar days after delivery. The customer may choose a replacement or a full refund. Return shipping is paid by Northstar.

Customer Care should record the serial number, symptom, delivery date, and any visible package damage. Photographs may help investigation but are not mandatory when the defect can be reproduced at a store or service center.

Safety complaints involving overheating, smoke, exposed wiring, or battery swelling must be escalated immediately and the customer must be advised to stop using the product.

5. Warranty coverage

Northstar-branded devices purchased on or after 1 July 2026 carry a 24-month limited hardware warranty. The warranty covers manufacturing defects under normal use. Products purchased before that date retain the warranty stated at the time of purchase.

Third-party products follow the manufacturer's warranty unless a Northstar protection plan extends coverage. Warranty service may involve repair, replacement with an equivalent unit, or a refund when neither option is practical.

The 24-month term supersedes the former 12-month standard referenced in older operational reports and training material. Staff must use the effective date and version number when resolving conflicting guidance.

6. Exclusions and special categories

Damage caused by unauthorized modification, deliberate misuse, liquid exposure outside the product rating, or use of an incompatible power supply is not a manufacturing defect. The claim may still be reviewed as a paid repair.

Opened hygiene-sensitive products, personalized goods, downloadable software, and activated prepaid services are normally non-returnable unless defective. Clearance items remain eligible for defect remedies.

Where consumer law provides a longer remedy period, the legal requirement takes priority. Employees should escalate uncertainty instead of refusing a claim based only on this summary.

7. Responsibilities, controls, and revision history

Customer Care verifies eligibility and records evidence. Store Operations inspects physical returns. Finance processes approved refunds. Vendor Operations receives recurring defect trends. Legal reviews regional exceptions.

Supervisors review a weekly sample of declined claims. A decline must contain the policy clause, evidence considered, and escalation path offered to the customer.

Revision 3.2: effective 1 July 2026; extended damaged-product returns to 30 days and Northstar hardware warranty to 24 months. Revision 2.8: effective 1 January 2025; previous 14-day damaged-product return guidance and 12-month Northstar warranty are superseded.